



Discussion Guide: Austin Channing Brown

The Double-Sided Pursuit of Racial Justice

Reflect

- Austin suggests that a two-fold approach is necessary for healing the damage of racism: denounce White supremacy and acknowledge the goodness of being Black. Which aspect of this approach do you think is more challenging? Why?
- Austin gives several examples of “conditional love” for Black people: “We love blackness as long as it is kicking a football, or dancing on a stage...as long as it is making money for us in the music industry...as long as it is articulate and upstanding.” Why is this a theological problem and not just a social or political one?
- Austin describes the noticeable difference between thinking and believing: thinking is knowing what is true, but believing means feeling and acting according to what is true. Regarding Austin’s call for racial justice, which of these is easier for you? For your community of faith? Does your community need to change in this regard?

Respond

- Where do you remember getting your initial understanding of race and racial relations? Did you ever receive it from a spiritual or religious source? If so, what was its impact on how you understand these issues? If not, why do think it was absent?
- Has there been a moment or conversation that significantly shifted your thoughts about race? What circumstances enabled this to happen?
- How can the church and people of faith create circumstances that allow people to see and hear the demand for racial justice in our worship? Community engagement? Activism? Interpretation of scripture?